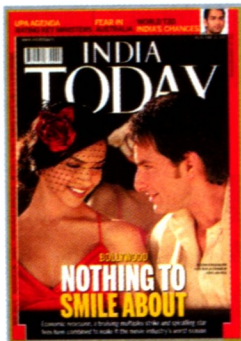


Nothing to Smile About

JUNE 22, 2009

Box office revenue down by Rs 100 crore from last year. Falling star fees. Negatives piled up in labs. Shelved projects and a bruising multiplex strike. Can the movie business have a happy ending?



“Bollywood’s worst season would probably make its super-earning, high-flying stars come down to earth. They can’t gobble up half the production costs and expect films to make profits now.”

K.CHIDANAND KUMAR, via www.indiatoday.in

Great Depression

The slack season in Bollywood has its beginnings in the recession going on in the country (“Bollywood’s Worst Season”, June 22). Stars’ inflated egos and prices have made filmmaking a costly and risky proposition. The time has come when they should make adjustments. Multiplexes might have to rethink their survival techniques and many of them might as well close down.

V.K. TANGRI, *Dehradun*

Marching Ahead

With no one to arm-twist or piggyback on, the UPA got everything in its favour (“M-77 and the art of Jugglery”, June 22). Therefore, there should be no excuses for non-performance or underperformance. There are a great



Hell Down Under

The ongoing racial attacks on Indian students as well as other foreigners in Australia will put their academic dreams and job prospects in jeopardy (“The Fear Factor”, June 15). Unless the Australian Government ensures speedy measures to resolve the crisis, there is every possibility of this snowballing into a messy and ugly affair for both countries.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

Till now, no serious probe into the genesis of the growing violent incidents appears to have been made either by the Indian High Commission in Australia or by local authorities. The Australian Government should take firm steps for the security of the students and instil confidence among them. Also, the media hype in India on the attacks is not warranted.

GANTI MAHAPATRUNI RAMA RAO, *Visakhapatnam*

deal of expectations from a cross-section of people. The unfinished tasks must be completed, with the agricultural and other rural-industrial sectors put on a firmer ground and restored to their former glory.

S. LAKSHMI,

via www.indiatoday.in

If it has taken 11 days to decide the composition of the Cabinet and allocation of portfolios, it is indicative of how difficult it must have been for Manmohan Singh to balance competing interests. It must be conceded that the prime minister has come up with a blend of women, youth and experience, not neglecting the aspiration of Dalits and minorities.

H.R.BAPU SATYANARAYANA,

via www.indiatoday.in

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